

Week 1 at a Glance

Wednesday–Saturday, September 9–12, 2026 · about two hours each morning

EVERY SCHOOL DAY

- Outdoor sit or walk, 20 min
- Bible, 10–15 min, then narrate
- Hymn or folk song, 5 min
- Ray’s Arithmetic, next lesson, 15–20 min
- Copywork, one line, 10 min
- Recitation, 5 min
- One main reading + narration
- One lighter reading or riches

HOLD ALL WEEK

Copywork: Slowly, silently, now the moon

Recitation: Genesis 1:1
In the beginning God created the heaven and the earth.

Hymn: first stanza of “I Bind Unto Myself Today”

Folk song: “The Bold Grenadier” — preview lyrics

Math: next Ray’s lesson. If opening fresh, start Ray’s Primary, oral work.

DAY	BIBLE	MAIN READING	RICHESS / EXTRA
Wed 9	Exodus 1	Island Story, “Harold”	Nature sit · “Silver” · hymn
Thu 10	Exodus 2	Little Duke, ch. 1 first half	Burgess Animal Book ch. 1 · folk song
Fri 11	Exodus 3	Two Gentlemen of Verona, start	Compass walk · Rockwell · hymn
Sat 12	Luke 19:1–9	Pilgrim’s Progress, gentle start	Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk

Books to have open

- Bible
- Ray’s Arithmetic
- *Our Island Story* (Marshall), ch. “Harold”
- *The Little Duke* (Yonge), ch. 1
- *Burgess Animal Book for Children*, ch. 1
- Nesbit or Lamb, *Two Gentlemen of Verona*
- de la Mare, “Silver” in *Peacock Pie*
- Cheap compass · nature notebook · pencils

Skip *Tree in the Trail* and *Trial and Triumph* unless you already own them.

Two children

The 2nd grader does the whole morning. The preschooler joins Bible, songs, poems, animal stories, picture study, and outside. During math, copywork, and heavier history they play nearby with quiet work.

Heat

Bastrop in September. Outside at 8am or after 6pm. Not midday. Times on the day pages slide; keep the order.

Free sources

Island Story: archive.org · Little Duke: Gutenberg 3048 · Burgess: Gutenberg 2441 · Lamb 573 or Nesbit 1430 · “Silver” in *Peacock Pie*, 1913.

READINGS IN THIS PACKET

After each day: the week’s assigned public-domain sitting, printed in full. Editions are labeled on those pages. Not printed: Cooper (title only), Rockwell images, Bernstein, *Tree in the Trail*, *Trial and Triumph*.

How to teach this week

Short lessons. Living books. One reading, then narration. You are not a textbook.

01 Narration is the lesson

Read once, close the book, let the child tell it back in their own words. You listen. Do not interrupt. Do not prompt with “and then what?” Wait. A few true sentences are enough. If they mix a name, let it stand unless the story broke. Thank them. Do not grade it.

02 Stop while they still want more

Fifteen to twenty minutes. A leftover page is better than a glazed child. If a chapter runs long, mark the spot and finish the next school day. Variety matters: Bible, then math, then a story, then a song. Do not stack two heavy readings.

03 Copywork, one line

Show the line. They copy it in their best handwriting, then stop. Not a paragraph. Not a worksheet. If the hand tires, fewer words tomorrow. This week’s line is from de la Mare: *Slowly, silently, now the moon*.

04 Recitation, a little every day

Say Genesis 1:1 together, then they try. No drill chart. When it sticks, add the first two lines of “Silver.” A poem learned by heart is a gift, not a test.

05 Ray’s Arithmetic

Oral work first when the book allows it. One lesson. Sit together. If they miss two in a row, stop and try those tomorrow. Do not add extra math from me.

06 Bible without a sermon

Read the passage. They narrate. You may add one true sentence. Do not turn Exodus into a lecture. Zacchaeus on Saturday is for both children.

07 Two children in one room

Preschooler sits for living stories, songs, poems, and nature. They are not expected to narrate Harold or Shakespeare. During math and copywork, give them quiet work in the same room: blocks, crayons, playdough, a basket of natural things. If they melt, send them outside and keep going with the 2nd grader.

08 Nature is looking, not naming

You are not a field guide. One thing: a pine, a web, a lizard, a cicada shell. Look. Draw. You may scribe one sentence they say. Names only if they ask. This week’s longer hunt is one invertebrate on Saturday evening.

09 Picture study

Look at Rockwell’s *Freedom of Speech* for four quiet minutes. Turn it over. They tell what was in the picture. Then look again. No art-history talk. Library book or a screen. Do not print a packet.

10 Music in the background

Play a short bit of Bernstein’s *Jeremiah* while they draw. Five to eight minutes. No quiz. If it is too heavy, still let it play once. Familiarity comes from hearing, not from explaining.

11 If it falls apart

Skip to outdoor time. Pick up tomorrow. These mornings are short so there is margin. A song and a walk still count as school.

12 Folk song caution

Preview “The Bold Grenadier” (also called “One Morning in May”). Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Hymn: only the first stanza of the Breastplate this month.

When Children Love to Learn

Elaine Cooper, ed. (Crossway, 2004). This week: Chapter 1 only, by title. Read it in your own copy. This page is not a reprint.

THIS WEEK'S READING

Chapter 1 · The Value of Charlotte Mason's Work for Today. About twenty minutes, sometime before Wednesday school. Not during the children's lessons.

What to do with it

Open your own book. Read the chapter. Do not take notes for a quiz. After you close it, watch for one moment this week when you almost rush a lesson or talk over a narration. Stop. Wait.

In the lessons

The 2nd grader is a person who can tell a story back.
The preschooler is a person too. Narration is how a person shows they know. Read once. Close the book. Let them talk.

Coming weeks

Week 2: Chapter 2, The Child is a Person.

Later: Chapter 3 (Atmosphere, Discipline, Life, Science of Relations), then Chapter 4 distinctives one at a time.

If you only do one thing

Read the chapter in your copy. Do not look here for Cooper's words. They are not printed.

This page names the chapter only. It is original notes pointing to your book. It is not a reprint of Cooper, of any contributor, or of Crossway.

Wednesday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn words · Ray's · copywork line · *Our Island Story* · "Silver" · nature notebook

8:00 **Nature sit** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Backyard or porch. Twenty minutes. One thing only: a pine, a lizard, a web, or a cicada shell. Look. Do not name everything. Sketch if they want. This drawing comes back on Saturday.

8:25 **Bible · Exodus 1**

New king. Israelites as slaves. The midwives. Read once. Close the Bible. Narrate. One true sentence from you if needed, then stop.

8:40 **Hymn** PRESCHOOLER JOINS

First stanza of "I Bind Unto Myself Today" (St. Patrick's Breastplate). Long hymn. Learn only the opening this month. Sing. Do not explain it to death.

8:50 **Ray's Arithmetic**

Next lesson, 15–20 min. Oral first if the book allows. Stop while attention is still on. Preschooler: quiet work nearby.

9:10 **Copywork & recitation**

Copy: *Slowly, silently, now the moon*. Best handwriting, then stop. Recite Genesis 1:1 together, then they try.

9:25 **History · *Our Island Story*, "Harold"**

King Harold, 1066, the Norman landing. Stop at 20 minutes if the chapter runs long. Narrate: who Harold was, and what happened to him. Place "Harold, 1066" on a simple timeline if you keep one.

9:50 **Movement, then poem**

Run around the house or stretch. Then read de la Mare's "Silver" once. No talk after unless they start it. Books done about 10:10. Free play.

If the morning slips, keep Bible, Ray's, Harold, and the nature sit. Drop the hymn and poem to tomorrow.

Bible · Exodus 1

King James Version (1611 / 1769 public-domain text). Project Gutenberg eBook #10.

1 Now these are the names of the children of Israel, which came into Egypt; every man and his household came with Jacob. 2 Reuben, Simeon, Levi, and Judah, 3 Issachar, Zebulun, and Benjamin, 4 Dan, and Naphtali, Gad, and Asher. 5 And all the souls that came out of the loins of Jacob were seventy souls: for Joseph was in Egypt already. 6 And Joseph died, and all his brethren, and all that generation. 7 And the children of Israel were fruitful, and increased abundantly, and multiplied, and waxed exceeding mighty; and the land was filled with them. 8 Now there arose up a new king over Egypt, which knew not Joseph. 9 And he said unto his people, Behold, the people of the children of Israel are more and mightier than we: 10 Come on, let us deal wisely with them; lest they multiply, and it come to pass, that, when there falleth out any war, they join also unto our enemies, and fight against us, and so get them up out of the land. 11 Therefore they did set over them taskmasters to afflict them with their burdens. And they built for Pharaoh treasure cities, Pithom and Raamses. 12 But the more they afflicted them, the more they multiplied and grew. And they were grieved because of the children of Israel. 13 And the Egyptians made the children of Israel to serve with rigour: 14 And they made their lives bitter with hard bondage, in mortar, and in brick, and in all manner of service in the field: all their service, wherein they made them serve, was with rigour. 15 And the king of Egypt spake to the Hebrew midwives, of which the name of the one was Shiphrah, and the name of the other Puah: 16 And he said, When ye do the office of a midwife to the Hebrew women, and see them upon the stools; if it be a son, then ye shall kill him: but if it be a daughter, then she shall live. 17 But the midwives feared God, and did not as the king of Egypt commanded them, but saved the men children alive. 18 And the king of Egypt called for the midwives, and said unto them, Why have ye done this thing, and have saved the men children alive? 19 And the midwives said unto Pharaoh, Because the Hebrew women are not as the Egyptian women; for they are lively, and are delivered ere the midwives come in unto them. 20 Therefore God dealt well with the midwives: and the people multiplied, and waxed very mighty. 21 And it came to pass, because the midwives feared God, that he made them houses. 22 And Pharaoh charged all his people, saying, Every son that is born ye shall cast into the river, and every daughter ye shall save alive.

Our Island Story · Chapter 22 · Harold

H. E. Marshall, An Island Story / Our Island Story: A Child's History of England. Frederick A. Stokes, New York, 1906 (same text as T.C. & E.C. Jack, London, 1905). Public domain. Heritage History transcription of that edition. Stokes printing: chapter begins p. 94 (Heritage History TOC: Harold p. 47 in some reprints).

When Edward the Confessor died, the people chose Harold Godwin to be their king, although he was not the real heir to the throne. The real heir was Edgar Ætheling, Edward's grand-nephew and grandson of Edmund Ironside, that king who had such a short and troubled reign and who fought so bravely against Canute the Dane.

But Edgar Ætheling was only a little boy. It seemed to the people as if he was not even an English boy, because he had lived all his life in a far-off country called Hungary, to which Canute had banished his father, and had come to England only a few months before Edward, his grand-uncle, had died. He did not understand the English language nor English ways, so nearly all the people looked upon him as a stranger. They were very tired of the strangers and foreigners with whom Edward had filled his court, and so they said, 'Let us have a real Englishman to rule over us, and one who is brave and wise.'

They knew Harold was brave, for he had already led them many times in battle. They knew that he was wise, because Edward, during the last years of his life, had been very ill and weak, and had allowed Harold to rule for him. And above all they knew Harold bitterly hated Edward's friends, the Norman nobles, and they were sure he would drive them out of the country. But they did not know what was perhaps Harold's chief reason for hating the Normans. They did not know that he had promised the crown of England to the most powerful of them all, William, Duke of Normandy.

So it came about that the day after Edward the Confessor was buried, the people crowded again to the grand new church at Westminster. This time they came to see the new king crowned. The church was filled with the nobles and the great people of the land. Outside the common folk and those who could not get inside waited, impatient to know what was happening.

It was in the beginning of January, and the weather was bitterly cold, but the people did not seem to mind that, so eager were they to see their new king as he passed. Although the wind blew keenly from the north, the sky was blue, and the winter sun shone brightly on the gay colours of their holiday clothes, making the gold ornaments of the women, and the helmets and shields of the soldiers, glitter and sparkle.

The day before, the streets had been full of grave and mourning crowds, sorrowing for the death of their king. This day there was no mourning, everything seemed joyful and glad, and hope shone in the faces of all. Only here and there in the crowd could be seen a few scowling Normans, but they soon slunk away, afraid of the fierce looks and angry words with which the Saxons greeted them.

Within the church all was solemn and quiet. After earnest prayer to God, the Archbishop of York, holding the crown in his hand, turned to the people. Harold knelt humbly at the steps of the high altar, while a breathless hush filled the great church from end to end. Then in the silence the voice of the old archbishop rang out clear and sharp, 'Do you choose Harold, Earl of Wessex, son of Godwin, to be your king?'

Like the thunder of the waves as they break upon the beach came the answer, 'We do, we do.'

The words sounded again and again through the aisles of the great church, echoing and re-echoing from the vaulted roof, till it seemed as if all England had answered. Outside the church the people took up the cry, 'Harold, son of Godwin, Harold, son of Godwin, Harold the Englishman for our king.'

In the silence which followed, Harold placed his hands between those of the archbishop, and promised to fear God, to rule wisely, and to keep the laws of the land.

Then the archbishop, speaking solemn words, anointed him with holy oil, placed the crown of England upon his head, and the sceptre in his hand.

Harold rose from his knees, no longer Earl of Wessex, but King of England. As he turned to the people he looked so brave, handsome, and kingly, that a cry of love and gratitude rose from them, and once again the arches of the great church rang with shouts. One after another the lords and mighty men of England passed before their king. They knelt to him, promising to be true to him, to fight for and obey him, just as he had promised them that he would try to rule well and be a good king.

At last the solemn ceremony was over. Harold passed down the long aisles, followed by the archbishop and bishops in their splendid robes, and the lords and knights in their shining armour. Out of the dim church into the open air they went; out into the sunshine where the people were waiting for their king. When Harold appeared, wearing the crown and royal robes and carrying the sceptre in his hand, they shouted and cheered again and again for joy. 'Harold for ever; Harold the King!' they cried.

So Harold was crowned, and all England was glad and at peace.

But the peace and the gladness did not last long. As soon as Harold was crowned, the few Normans who still remained in England fled to Normandy. They went to Rouen, the town in Normandy where Duke William lived.

Nowadays, if one wants to speak to a king, or great prince, it is not always easy, for soldiers and servants guard the doors. But in those days it was much more easy, so one of these Normans who fled from England went to find Duke William, for he knew he had great news to tell. William was out hunting when this messenger from England arrived. He was so eager to tell the news that he could not wait until the duke returned, but followed him into the park. He searched about for some time, and at last saw William riding towards him surrounded by all his lords and ladies, his falcon on his wrist, and his bow in his hand. The duke looked so splendid and powerful that the messenger was almost afraid to tell the news he brought. 'My lord,' he said, dropping on his knees, 'Edward, King of England, is dead.'

Duke William's bright eyes shone with joy.

'Ah!' he exclaimed.

'And Harold, son of Godwin, is crowned king in his stead,' went on the man.

Then Duke William's eyes flashed fire, his bow dropped from his hand, his face grew red and dark with anger.

'The Saxon dog, the oath-breaker,' he thundered, in a voice which made those who heard him tremble. Then he was silent, and those around him were silent too, trembling in fear before the awful wrath of their lord.

For many minutes William sat in dumb rage, clasping and unclasping the rich cloak which fell from his shoulders. Then, still without uttering a word, he turned and rode back to his palace. He seemed neither to see nor hear anything, but throwing himself on a couch, he buried his face in his cloak, and gave himself up to angry thoughts.

His courtiers stood round whispering and frightened. At last one, more bold than the others, went up to him, and laying his hand upon the duke's shoulder, 'Rouse yourself, my lord,' he said, 'you have a message to send to Harold Godwinson, before the common folk hear how he has insulted you.'

'Ay, that have I,' said William fiercely. Then he called for the man who had brought the news.

He came in fear and trembling, but William only looked darkly at him. 'Go,' he said after a pause, 'go back to England. Tell Harold Godwinson (he would not call him King Harold) that I, William of Normandy, demand the crown and throne of England. Tell him if he will not give it peaceably, that I will come and take it by force.'

So the messenger returned to England, and came to Harold as he was sitting in state surrounded by his lords and nobles. Harold listened quietly to the message. Then in a clear and calm voice he replied, 'Go tell your master that the crown and throne of England are not mine to give and take at will. Tell him that the people of England have given them to me in trust, and that while I live, I will keep and guard them as best I can. Let William of Normandy beware!'

When the messenger returned to Rouen with this message, William's anger was terrible. At first he could neither speak nor think for rage, but soon he recovered himself and called all his lords together. He asked them to go with him over the sea, to help him to fight Harold and make himself King of England.

But his lords and nobles refused. 'It is a very dangerous thing to do,' they said. 'These English are a great and brave people. They will kill us all. We will not go.'

Although William was lord over these men, he could not force them to go across the sea with him. He could only ask them to go. He was very angry with them for refusing, so he broke up the council and sent all the nobles away. Then he made each one come to him alone, and tried to persuade them, one by one, to go with him over the sea to England.

But it was of no use, one after another they refused. 'It is all very well for you,' they said, 'if you win you will have the crown of England; but as for us, those of us who are not killed will return poorer than before. We will not go.'

Then Duke William said, 'If you will only come with me I will give you fair lands, strong castles, and great stores of money. England is a rich country, and when I have conquered the people, I will take their lands and money away from them and give them to you.'

Then all the nobles answered, 'We will go.'

After that they went to their own homes to gather their soldiers together, and to prepare armour and weapons for battle. But William was not content with the soldiers which his own Norman nobles had promised. He sent messengers into all parts of France, with the promise of land and money as reward, to every one who would come to fight for him.

Very many came. From far and near they flocked to the court of William, glad at the thought of possessing the green fields and broad forest lands of England.

But William had not ships enough to carry so large a company over the sea, so he bought ships, and made people build them for him, paying sometimes with money, sometimes with promises of English land.

Never was such a wonderful army and so great a fleet gathered together in so short a time.

But William was a great leader. He was fierce, strong, and determined. He had set his heart on being King of England, and King of England he meant to be. So night and day he planned and worked, persuading and forcing people in one way or another to help him.

Stop here. Do not start chapter 23, "The Battle of Stamford Bridge." That is next week.

Silver

Walter de la Mare, *Peacock Pie: A Book of Rhymes* (1913). Project Gutenberg eBook #3753. Poem in full.

*Slowly, silently, now the moon
Walks the night in her silver shoon:
This way, and that, she peers and sees
Silver fruit upon silver trees;
One by one the casements catch
Her beams beneath the silvery thatch;
Couched in his kennel, like a log,
With paws of silver sleeps the dog
From their shadowy cote the white breasts peep
Of doves in a silver-feathered sleep;
A harvest mouse goes scampering by,
With silver claws and silver eye;
And moveless fish in the water gleam
By silver reeds in a silver stream.*

DAY TWO

SEPTEMBER 10, 2026

Thursday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song (previewed) · Ray's · *The Little Duke* · *Burgess Animal Book* ch. 1

8:00

Short yard time OPTIONAL

Ten minutes if Wednesday's sit went well. Or skip and save the long walk for Saturday evening.

8:20

Bible · Exodus 2 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Baby Moses, the basket, the Egyptian, flight to Midian. Read once. Narrate. The preschooler will hold the basket; the 2nd grader should hold the whole thread.

8:35

Folk song

"The Bold Grenadier," also sung as "One Morning in May." Preview the lyrics first. Some old verses are not for children. Sing a clean set. Both children.

8:45

Ray's, copywork, recitation

Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: *Slowly, silently, now the moon*. Recitation: Genesis 1:1. If the verse is sticking, add the first two lines of "Silver" at the end of the morning.

9:20

Tales · *The Little Duke*, ch. 1 first half

A boy named Richard in Normandy. Read the first half only. Stop even if they beg. Narrate who Richard is and where he lives. Gutenberg 3048 if you need the text.

9:50

Natural history · Burgess ch. 1 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

“Jenny Wren Gives Peter Rabbit an Idea.” Both children. This is the easy living-science of the week. Narrate. Peter is about to go to school under Old Mother Nature; that is enough for today.

10:10

Done

Books finished. If anyone is still bright, reread “Silver.” Do not add another chapter.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray’s, Little Duke, and Burgess. Folk song can wait for Saturday.

Bible · Exodus 2

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain.

1 And there went a man of the house of Levi, and took to wife a daughter of Levi. 2 And the woman conceived, and bare a son: and when she saw him that he was a goodly child, she hid him three months. 3 And when she could not longer hide him, she took for him an ark of bulrushes, and daubed it with slime and with pitch, and put the child therein; and she laid it in the flags by the river's brink. 4 And his sister stood afar off, to wit what would be done to him. 5 And the daughter of Pharaoh came down to wash herself at the river; and her maidens walked along by the river's side; and when she saw the ark among the flags, she sent her maid to fetch it. 6 And when she had opened it, she saw the child: and, behold, the babe wept. And she had compassion on him, and said, This is one of the Hebrews' children. 7 Then said his sister to Pharaoh's daughter, Shall I go and call to thee a nurse of the Hebrew women, that she may nurse the child for thee? 8 And Pharaoh's daughter said to her, Go. And the maid went and called the child's mother. 9 And Pharaoh's daughter said unto her, Take this child away, and nurse it for me, and I will give thee thy wages. And the woman took the child, and nursed it. 10 And the child grew, and she brought him unto Pharaoh's daughter, and he became her son. And she called his name Moses: and she said, Because I drew him out of the water. 11 And it came to pass in those days, when Moses was grown, that he went out unto his brethren, and looked on their burdens: and he spied an Egyptian smiting an Hebrew, one of his brethren. 12 And he looked this way and that way, and when he saw that there was no man, he slew the Egyptian, and hid him in the sand. 13 And when he went out the second day, behold, two men of the Hebrews strove together: and he said to him that did the wrong, Wherefore smitest thou thy fellow? 14 And he said, Who made thee a prince and a judge over us? intendest thou to kill me, as thou killedst the Egyptian? And Moses feared, and said, Surely this thing is known. 15 Now when Pharaoh heard this thing, he sought to slay Moses. But Moses fled from the face of Pharaoh, and dwelt in the land of Midian: and he sat down by a well. 16 Now the priest of Midian had seven daughters: and they came and drew water, and filled the troughs to water their father's flock. 17 And the shepherds came and drove them away: but Moses stood up and helped them, and watered their flock. 18 And when they came to Reuel their father, he said, How is it that ye are come so soon to day? 19 And they said, An Egyptian delivered us out of the hand of the shepherds, and also drew water enough for us, and watered the flock. 20 And he said unto his daughters, And where is he? why is it that ye have left the man? call him, that he may eat bread. 21 And Moses was content to dwell with the man: and he gave Moses Zipporah his daughter. 22 And she bare him a son, and he called his name Gershom: for he said, I have been a stranger in a strange land. 23 And it came to pass in process of time, that the king of Egypt died: and the children of Israel sighed by reason of the bondage, and they cried, and their cry came up unto God by reason of the bondage. 24 And God heard their groaning, and God remembered his covenant with Abraham, with Isaac, and with Jacob. 25 And God looked upon the children of Israel, and God had respect unto them.

The Little Duke · Chapter 1, first half

Charlotte M. Yonge, The Little Duke: Richard the Fearless. Macmillan, London, 1905 (Gutenberg #3048). Public domain. This sitting: the castle at Bayeux, the hunt, Richard made ready, Duke William arrives and is welcomed. Stop before the feast.

On a bright autumn day, as long ago as the year 943, there was a great bustle in the Castle of Bayeux in Normandy.

The hall was large and low, the roof arched, and supported on thick short columns, almost like the crypt of a Cathedral; the walls were thick, and the windows, which had no glass, were very small, set in such a depth of wall that there was a wide deep window seat, upon which the rain might beat, without reaching the interior of the room. And even if it had come in, there was nothing for it to hurt, for the walls were of rough stone, and the floor of tiles. There was a fire at each end of this great dark apartment, but there were no chimneys over the ample hearths, and the smoke curled about in thick white folds in the vaulted roof, adding to the wreaths of soot, which made the hall look still darker.

The fire at the lower end was by far the largest and hottest. Great black cauldrons hung over it, and servants, both men and women, with red faces, bare and grimed arms, and long iron hooks, or pots and pans, were busied around it. At the other end, which was raised about three steps above the floor of the hall, other servants were engaged. Two young maidens were strewing fresh rushes on the floor; some men were setting up a long table of rough boards, supported on trestles, and then ranging upon it silver cups, drinking horns, and wooden trenchers.

Benches were placed to receive most of the guests, but in the middle, at the place of honour, was a high chair with very thick crossing legs, and the arms curiously carved with lions' faces and claws; a clumsy wooden footstool was set in front, and the silver drinking-cup on the table was of far more beautiful workmanship than the others, richly chased with vine leaves and grapes, and figures of little boys with goats' legs. If that cup could have told its story, it would have been a strange one, for it had been made long since, in the old Roman times, and been carried off from Italy by some Northman pirate.

From one of these scenes of activity to the other, there moved a stately old lady: her long thick light hair, hardly touched with grey, was bound round her head, under a tall white cap, with a band passing under her chin: she wore a long sweeping dark robe, with wide hanging sleeves, and thick gold ear-rings and necklace, which had possibly come from the same quarter as the cup. She directed the servants, inspected both the cookery and arrangements of the table, held council with an old steward, now and then looked rather anxiously from the window, as if expecting some one, and began to say something about fears that these loitering youths would not bring home the venison in time for Duke William's supper.

Presently, she looked up rejoiced, for a few notes of a bugle-horn were sounded; there was a clattering of feet, and in a few moments there bounded into the hall, a boy of about eight years old, his cheeks and large blue eyes bright with air and exercise, and his long light-brown hair streaming behind him, as he ran forward flourishing a bow in his hand, and crying out, "I hit him, I hit him! Dame Astrida, do you hear? 'Tis a stag of ten branches, and I hit him in the neck."

"You! my Lord Richard! you killed him?"

"Oh, no, I only struck him. It was Osmond's shaft that took him in the eye, and--Look you, Fru Astrida, he came thus through the wood, and I stood here, it might be, under the great elm with my bow thus"--And Richard was beginning to act over again the whole scene of the deer-hunt, but Fru, that is to say, Lady Astrida, was too busy to listen, and broke in with, "Have they brought home the haunch?"

"Yes, Walter is bringing it. I had a long arrow--"

A stout forester was at this instant seen bringing in the venison, and Dame Astrida hastened to meet it, and gave directions, little Richard following her all the way, and talking as eagerly as if she was attending to him, showing how he shot, how Osmond shot, how the deer bounded, and how it fell, and then counting the branches of its antlers, always ending with, "This is something to tell my father. Do you think he will come soon?"

In the meantime two men entered the hall, one about fifty, the other, one or two-and-twenty, both in hunting dresses of plain leather, crossed by broad embroidered belts, supporting a knife, and a bugle-horn. The elder was broad-shouldered, sun-burnt, ruddy, and rather stern-looking; the younger, who was also the taller, was slightly made, and very active, with a bright keen grey eye, and merry smile. These were Dame Astrida's son, Sir Eric de Centeville, and her grandson, Osmond; and to their care Duke William of Normandy had committed his only child, Richard, to be fostered, or brought up.

It was always the custom among the Northmen, that young princes should thus be put under the care of some trusty vassal, instead of being brought up at home, and one reason why the Centevilles had been chosen by Duke William was, that both Sir Eric and his mother spoke only the old Norwegian tongue, which he wished young Richard to understand well, whereas, in other parts of the Duchy, the Normans had forgotten their own tongue, and had taken up what was then called the Langued'oui, a language between German and Latin, which was the beginning of French.

On this day, Duke William himself was expected at Bayeux, to pay a visit to his son before setting out on a journey to settle the disputes between the Counts of Flanders and Montreuil, and this was the reason of Fru Astrida's great preparations. No sooner had she seen the haunch placed upon a spit, which a little boy was to turn before the fire, than she turned to dress something else, namely, the young Prince Richard himself, whom she led off to one of the upper rooms, and there he had full time to talk, while she, great lady though she was, herself combed smooth his long flowing curls, and fastened his short scarlet cloth tunic, which just reached to his knee, leaving his neck, arms, and legs bare. He begged hard to be allowed to wear a short, beautifully ornamented dagger at his belt, but this Fru Astrida would not allow.

"You will have enough to do with steel and dagger before your life is at an end," said she, "without seeking to begin over soon."

"To be sure I shall," answered Richard. "I will be called Richard of the Sharp Axe, or the Bold Spirit, I promise you, Fru Astrida. We are as brave in these days as the Sigurds and Ragnars you sing of! I only wish there were serpents and dragons to slay here in Normandy."

"Never fear but you will find even too many of them," said Dame Astrida; "there be dragons of wrong here and everywhere, quite as venomous as any in my Sagas."

"I fear them not," said Richard, but half understanding her, "if you would only let me have the dagger! But, hark! hark!" he darted to the window. "They come, they come! There is the banner of Normandy."

Away ran the happy child, and never rested till he stood at the bottom of the long, steep, stone stair, leading to the embattled porch. Thither came the Baron de Centeville, and his son, to receive their Prince. Richard looked up at Osmond, saying, "Let me hold his stirrup," and then sprang up and shouted for joy, as under the arched gateway there came a tall black horse, bearing the stately form of the Duke of Normandy. His purple robe was fastened round him by a rich belt, sustaining the mighty weapon, from which he was called "William of the long Sword," his legs and feet were cased in linked steel chain-work, his gilded spurs were on his heels, and his short brown hair was covered by his ducal cap of purple, turned up with fur, and a feather fastened in by a jewelled clasp. His brow was grave and thoughtful, and there was something both of dignity and sorrow in his face, at the first moment of looking at it, recalling the recollection that he had early lost his young wife, the Duchess Emma, and that he was beset by many cares and toils; but the next glance generally conveyed encouragement, so full of mildness were his eyes, and so kind the expression of his lips.

And now, how bright a smile beamed upon the little Richard, who, for the first time, paid him the duty of a pupil in chivalry, by holding the stirrup while he sprung from his horse. Next, Richard knelt to receive his blessing, which was always the custom when children met their parents. The Duke laid his hand on his head, saying, "God of His

mercy bless thee, my son," and lifting him in his arms, held him to his breast, and let him cling to his neck and kiss him again and again, before setting him down, while Sir Eric came forward, bent his knee, kissed the hand of his Prince, and welcomed him to his Castle.

Stop here. The father's visit — the feast, the talk, the silver key — is next week. Do not open chapter 2.

The Burgess Animal Book · Chapter 1

Thornton W. Burgess, The Burgess Animal Book for Children (1920). Project Gutenberg eBook #2441. Chapter I, "Jenny Wren Gives Peter Rabbit an Idea," in full. Often pp. 1–5 in the 1920 printing.

"As sure as you're alive now, Peter Rabbit, some day I will catch you," snarled Reddy Fox, as he poked his black nose in the hole between the roots of the Big Hickory-tree which grows close to the Smiling Pool. "It is lucky for you that you were not one jump farther away from this hole."

Peter, safe inside that hole, didn't have a word to say, or, if he did, he didn't have breath enough to say it. It was quite true that if he had been one jump farther from that hole, Reddy Fox would have caught him. As it was, the hairs on Peter's funny white tail actually had tickled Reddy's back as Peter plunged frantically through the root-bound entrance to that hole. It had been the narrowest escape Peter had had for a long, long time. You see, Reddy Fox had surprised Peter nibbling sweet clover on the bank of the Smiling Pond, and it had been a lucky thing for Peter that that hole, dug long ago by Johnny Chuck's grandfather, had been right where it was. Also, it was a lucky thing that old Mr. Chuck had been wise enough to make the entrance between the roots of that tree in such a way that it could not be dug any larger.

Reddy Fox was too shrewd to waste any time trying to dig it larger. He knew there wasn't room enough for him to get between those roots. So, after trying to make Peter as uncomfortable as possible by telling him what he, Reddy, would do to him when he did catch him, Reddy trotted off across the Green Meadows. Peter remained where he was for a long time. When he was quite sure that it was safe to do so, he crept out and hurried, lipperty-lipperty-lip, up to the Old Orchard. He felt that that would be the safest place for him, because there were ever so many hiding places in the old stone wall along the edge of it.

When Peter reached the Old Orchard, who should he see but Jenny Wren. Jenny had arrived that very morning from the Sunny South where she had spent the winter. "Tut, tut, tut, tut, tut!" exclaimed Jenny as soon as she saw Peter. "If here isn't Peter Rabbit himself! How did you manage to keep out of the clutches of Reddy Fox all the long winter?"

Peter chuckled. "I didn't have much trouble with Reddy during the winter," said he, "but this very morning he so nearly caught me that it is a wonder that my hair is not snow white from fright." Then he told Jenny all about his narrow escape. "Had it not been for that handy hole of Grandfather Chuck, I couldn't possibly have escaped," concluded Peter.

Jenny Wren cocked her pert little head on one side, and her sharp little eyes snapped. "Why don't you learn to swim, Peter, like your cousin down in the Sunny South?" she demanded. "If he had been in your place, he would simply have plunged into the Smiling Pool and laughed at Reddy Fox."

Peter sat bolt upright with his eyes very wide open. In them was a funny look of surprise as he stared up at Jenny Wren. "What are you talking about, Jenny Wren?" he demanded. "Don't you know that none of the Rabbit family swim unless it is to cross the Laughing Brook when there is no other way of getting to the other side, or when actually driven into the water by an enemy from whom there is no other escape? I can swim a little if I have to, but you don't catch me in the water when I can stay on land. What is more, you won't find any other members of my family doing such a thing."

"Tut, tut, tut, tut, Peter!" exclaimed Jenny Wren in her sharp, scolding voice. "Tut, tut, tut, tut! For a fellow who has been so curious about the ways of his feathered neighbors, you know very little about your own family. If I were in your place I would learn about my own relatives before I became curious about my neighbors. How many relatives have you, Peter?"

"One," replied Peter promptly, "my big cousin, Jumper the Hare."

Jenny Wren threw back her head and laughed and laughed and laughed. It was a most irritating and provoking laugh. Finally Peter began to lose patience. "What are you laughing at?" he demanded crossly. "You know very well that Jumper the Hare is the only cousin I have."

Jenny Wren laughed harder than ever.

"Peter!" she gasped. "Peter, you will be the death of me. Why, down in the Sunny South, where I spent the winter, you have a cousin who is more closely related to you than Jumper the Hare. And what is more, he is almost as fond of the water as Jerry Muskrat. He was called the Marsh Rabbit or Marsh Hare, and many a time I have watched him swimming about by the hour."

"I don't believe it!" declared Peter angrily. "I don't believe a word of it. You are simply trying to fool me, Jenny Wren. There never was a Rabbit and there never will be a Rabbit who would go swimming for the fun of it. I belong to the Cottontail branch of the Hare family, and it is a fine family if I do say so. My cousin Jumper is a true Hare, and the only difference between us is that he is bigger, has longer legs and ears, changes the color of his coat in winter, and seldom, if ever, goes into holes in the ground. The idea of trying to tell me I don't know about my own relatives."

Jenny Wren suddenly became sober. "Peter," said she very earnestly, "take my advice and go to school to Old Mother Nature for awhile. What I have told you is true, every word of it. You have a cousin down in the Sunny South who spends half his time in the water. What is more, I suspect that you and Jumper have other relatives of whom you've never heard. Such ignorance would be laughable if it were not to be pitied. This is what comes of never having traveled. Go to school to Old Mother Nature for a while, Peter. It will pay you." With this, Jenny Wren flew away to hunt for Mr. Wren that they might decide where to make their home for the summer.

Peter tried to believe that what Jenny Wren had told him was nothing but a story, but do what he would, he couldn't rid himself of a little doubt. He tried to interest himself in the affairs of the other little people of Old Orchard, but it was useless. That little doubt kept growing and growing. Could it be possible that Jenny Wren had spoken the truth? Could it be that he really didn't know what relatives he had or anything about them? Of course Old Mother Nature could tell him all he wanted to know. And he knew that whatever she might tell him would be true.

Finally that growing doubt, together with the curiosity which has led poor Peter to do so many queer things, proved too much for him and he started for the Green Forest to look for Old Mother Nature. It didn't take long to find her. She was very busy, for there is no time in all the year when Old Mother Nature has quite so much to do as in the spring.

"If you please, Old Mother Nature," said Peter timidly but very politely, "I've some questions I want to ask you."

Old Mother Nature's eyes twinkled in a kindly way. "All right, Peter," she replied. "I guess I can talk and work at the same time. What is it you want to know?"

"I want to know if it is true that there are any other members of the Rabbit and the Hare family besides my big cousin, Jumper, who lives here in the Green Forest, and myself."

Old Mother Nature's eyes twinkled more than ever. "Why, of course, Peter," she replied. "There are several other members. You ought to know that. But then, I suppose you don't because you never have traveled. It is surprising how little some folks know about the very things they ought to know most about."

Peter looked very humble and as if he felt a little bit foolish. "Is--is--is it true that way down in the Sunny South I have a cousin who loves to spend his time in the water?" stammered Peter.

"It certainly is, Peter," replied Old Mother Nature. "He is called the Marsh Rabbit, and he is more nearly your size, and looks more like you, than any of your other cousins."

Peter gulped as if he were swallowing something that went down hard. "That is what Jenny Wren said, but I didn't believe her," replied Peter meekly. "She said she had often watched him swimming about like Jerry Muskrat."

Old Mother Nature nodded. “Quite true. Quite true,” said she. “He is quite as much at home in the water as on land, if anything a little more so. He is one member the family who takes to the water, and he certainly does love it. Is there anything else you want to know, Peter?”

Peter shifted about uneasily and hesitated. “What is it, Peter?” asked Old Mother Nature kindly. “There is nothing in the Great World equal to knowledge, and if I can add to your store of it I will be very glad to.”

Peter took heart. “If--if you please, Mother Nature, I would like to learn all about my family. May come to school to you every day?”

Old Mother Nature laughed right out. “Certainly you may go to school to me, old Mr. Curiosity,” said she. “It is a good idea; a very good idea. I'm very busy, as you can see, but I'm never too busy to teach those who really want to learn. We'll have a lesson here every morning just at sun-up. I can't be bothered any more to-day, because it is late. Run along home to the dear Old Briar-patch and think up some questions to ask me to-morrow morning. And, by the way, Peter, I will ask YOU some questions. For one thing I shall ask you to tell me all you know about your own family. Now scamper along and be here to-morrow morning at sun-up.”

“May I bring my cousin, Jumper the Hare, if he wants to come?” asked Peter, as he prepared to obey Old Mother Nature.

“Bring him along and any one else who wants to learn,” replied Old Mother Nature kindly.

Peter bade her good-by in his most polite manner and then scampered as fast as he could go, lipperty-lipperty-lip, to the dear Old Briar-patch. There he spent the remainder of the day thinking up questions and also trying to find out how much he really did know about his own family.

DAY THREE

SEPTEMBER 11, 2026

Friday

HAVE READY

Bible · hymn · Ray's · Shakespeare tale (Nesbit or Lamb) · cheap compass · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

8:20

Bible · Exodus 3

The burning bush. Read once. Narrate. Let the strange fire sit. You do not need to unpack every name of God today.

8:35

Hymn, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Same stanza as Wednesday. Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the moon line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1.

Preschooler: quiet work through math and copywork, then they may come for Shakespeare and picture study if they will sit.

9:20

Shakespeare · start *The Two Gentlemen of Verona*

Nesbit's *Beautiful Stories* or Lamb's *Tales*. One sitting. Do not finish the play. The next AO play is not for weeks. Narrate whatever you actually read: who the gentlemen are, and what the first tangle is. If it is too talky, stop after a few pages. That still counts.

9:50

Geography · compass PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Go outside. Cheap compass. North, south, east, west. Hide the compass. Let the 2nd grader point. Preschooler plays “find north.” If the sun is up, notice which wall it hits in the morning. No worksheet.

10:10

Picture study · Rockwell, *Freedom of Speech*

Look four minutes in silence. Turn it over. Child tells what was there (the standing man, the town meeting, the faces). Look once more. Library book or a museum image on a screen. Do not print a homemade packet. Copyright still holds; looking is the lesson.

If you must cut: keep Bible, Ray’s, compass, and picture study. Shakespeare can split into next week.

Bible · Exodus 3

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain.

1 Now Moses kept the flock of Jethro his father in law, the priest of Midian: and he led the flock to the backside of the desert, and came to the mountain of God, even to Horeb. 2 And the angel of the LORD appeared unto him in a flame of fire out of the midst of a bush: and he looked, and, behold, the bush burned with fire, and the bush was not consumed. 3 And Moses said, I will now turn aside, and see this great sight, why the bush is not burnt. 4 And when the LORD saw that he turned aside to see, God called unto him out of the midst of the bush, and said, Moses, Moses. And he said, Here am I. 5 And he said, Draw not nigh hither: put off thy shoes from off thy feet, for the place whereon thou standest is holy ground. 6 Moreover he said, I am the God of thy father, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob. And Moses hid his face; for he was afraid to look upon God. 7 And the LORD said, I have surely seen the affliction of my people which are in Egypt, and have heard their cry by reason of their taskmasters; for I know their sorrows; 8 And I am come down to deliver them out of the hand of the Egyptians, and to bring them up out of that land unto a good land and a large, unto a land flowing with milk and honey; unto the place of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites. 9 Now therefore, behold, the cry of the children of Israel is come unto me: and I have also seen the oppression wherewith the Egyptians oppress them. 10 Come now therefore, and I will send thee unto Pharaoh, that thou mayest bring forth my people the children of Israel out of Egypt. 11 And Moses said unto God, Who am I, that I should go unto Pharaoh, and that I should bring forth the children of Israel out of Egypt? 12 And he said, Certainly I will be with thee; and this shall be a token unto thee, that I have sent thee: When thou hast brought forth the people out of Egypt, ye shall serve God upon this mountain. 13 And Moses said unto God, Behold, when I come unto the children of Israel, and shall say unto them, The God of your fathers hath sent me unto you; and they shall say to me, What is his name? what shall I say unto them? 14 And God said unto Moses, I AM THAT I AM: and he said, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, I AM hath sent me unto you. 15 And God said moreover unto Moses, Thus shalt thou say unto the children of Israel, the LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, the God of Isaac, and the God of Jacob, hath sent me unto you: this is my name for ever, and this is my memorial unto all generations. 16 Go, and gather the elders of Israel together, and say unto them, The LORD God of your fathers, the God of Abraham, of Isaac, and of Jacob, appeared unto me, saying, I have surely visited you, and seen that which is done to you in Egypt: 17 And I have said, I will bring you up out of the affliction of Egypt unto the land of the Canaanites, and the Hittites, and the Amorites, and the Perizzites, and the Hivites, and the Jebusites, unto a land flowing with milk and honey. 18 And they shall hearken to thy voice: and thou shalt come, thou and the elders of Israel, unto the king of Egypt, and ye shall say unto him, The LORD God of the Hebrews hath met with us: and now let us go, we beseech thee, three days' journey into the wilderness, that we may sacrifice to the LORD our God. 19 And I am sure that the king of Egypt will not let you go, no, not by a mighty hand. 20 And I will stretch out my hand, and smite Egypt with all my wonders which I will do in the midst thereof: and after that he will let you go. 21 And I will give this people favour in the sight of the Egyptians: and it shall come to pass, that, when ye go, ye shall not go empty. 22 But every woman shall borrow of her neighbour, and of her that sojourneth in her house, jewels of silver, and jewels of gold, and raiment: and ye shall put them upon your sons, and upon your daughters; and ye shall spoil the Egyptians.

The Two Gentlemen of Verona · first sitting

E. Nesbit, Beautiful Stories from Shakespeare. Project Gutenberg eBook #1430. Public domain. Nesbit's tale is shorter than Lamb (Gutenberg #573); this is one sitting of Nesbit, not the whole play and not the rest of the tale.

Only one of them was really a gentleman, as you will discover later. Their names were Valentine and Proteus. They were friends, and lived at Verona, a town in northern Italy. Valentine was happy in his name because it was that of the patron saint of lovers; it is hard for a Valentine to be fickle or mean. Proteus was unhappy in his name, because it was that of a famous shape-changer, and therefore it encouraged him to be a lover at one time and a traitor at another.

One day, Valentine told his friend that he was going to Milan. "I'm not in love like you," said he, "and therefore I don't want to stay at home."

Proteus was in love with a beautiful yellow-haired girl called Julia, who was rich, and had no one to order her about. He was, however, sorry to part from Valentine, and he said, "If ever you are in danger tell me, and I will pray for you." Valentine then went to Milan with a servant called Speed, and at Milan he fell in love with the Duke of Milan's daughter, Silvia.

When Proteus and Valentine parted Julia had not acknowledged that she loved Proteus. Indeed, she had actually torn up one of his letters in the presence of her maid, Lucetta. Lucetta, however, was no simpleton, for when she saw the pieces she said to herself, "All she wants is to be annoyed by another letter." Indeed, no sooner had Lucetta left her alone than Julia repented of her tearing, and placed between her dress and her heart the torn piece of paper on which Proteus had signed his name. So by tearing a letter written by Proteus she discovered that she loved him. Then, like a brave, sweet girl, she wrote to Proteus, "Be patient, and you shall marry me."

Delighted with these words Proteus walked about, flourishing Julia's letter and talking to himself.

"What have you got there?" asked his father, Antonio.

"A letter from Valentine," fibbed Proteus.

"Let me read it," said Antonio.

"There is no news," said deceitful Proteus; "he only says that he is very happy, and the Duke of Milan is kind to him, and that he wishes I were with him."

This fib had the effect of making Antonio think that his son should go to Milan and enjoy the favors in which Valentine basked. "You must go to-morrow," he decreed. Proteus was dismayed. "Give me time to get my outfit ready." He was met with the promise, "What you need shall be sent after you."

It grieved Julia to part from her lover before their engagement was two days' old. She gave him a ring, and said, "Keep this for my sake," and he gave her a ring, and they kissed like two who intend to be true till death. Then Proteus departed for Milan.

Meanwhile Valentine was amusing Silvia, whose grey eyes, laughing at him under auburn hair, had drowned him in love. One day she told him that she wanted to write a pretty letter to a gentleman whom she thought well of, but had no time: would he write it? Very much did Valentine dislike writing that letter, but he did write it, and gave it to her coldly. "Take it back," she said; "you did it unwillingly."

"Madam," he said, "it was difficult to write such a letter for you."

"Take it back," she commanded; "you did not write tenderly enough."

Valentine was left with the letter, and condemned to write another; but his servant Speed saw that, in effect, the Lady Silvia had allowed Valentine to write for her a love-letter to Valentine's own self. "The joke," he said, "is as invisible as a weather-cock on a steeple." He meant that it was very plain; and he went on to say exactly what it was: "If master will write her love-letters, he must answer them."

Stop here. You have met Valentine and Proteus, and the first tangle (Julia's letter; Silvia's letter-joke). The rest of the tale waits. Do not finish the play.

DAY FOUR · LONGER OUTDOOR TIME AFTER 6

SEPTEMBER 12, 2026

Saturday

HAVE READY

Bible · folk song · Ray's · a simple way to tell Pilgrim's Progress · Bernstein excerpt · nature notebook · evening walk plan

8:20

Bible · Luke 19:1–9 PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Zacchaeus. Both children. Read once. Narrate. This is the joyful reading of the week. Let them climb the tree in the telling.

8:35

Folk song, Ray's, copywork, recitation

Clean verses of "The Bold Grenadier." Next Ray's lesson. Copywork: the moon line. Recitation: Genesis 1:1, and "Silver" if it has begun to stick.

9:20

Literature · *Pilgrim's Progress*, a gentle start

Do not start with the verse preface. In five minutes, tell that this is a story of a man named Christian who leaves home and travels to the Celestial City. If they want more, read the opening of the dream ("As I walked through the wilderness of this world...") and stop. Narrate. The City of Destruction waiting can wait until a later week.

9:45

Composer · Bernstein, *Jeremiah*

Five to eight minutes of Symphony No. 1 while they draw. Legal stream or library recording. No quiz. If it feels heavy, that is all right. Hearing it once is the whole lesson.

10:00

Handicraft · nature notebook PRESCHOOLER JOINS

Draw Wednesday's pine, web, or bug. You may scribe one sentence they say, dated. This is the handicraft. Keep it twenty minutes. Stop while the drawing still pleases them.

After 6

Evening walk · Lost Pines or a creek

Bastrop heat. Not midday. Prompt: find one invertebrate (spider, cricket, ant, caterpillar). Look. Not a field-guide test. Draw later only if they ask. A song on the way home still counts.

Week 1 is done when Saturday's walk is done. Next week's plan lands Tuesday morning.

Bible · Luke 19:1–9

King James Version. Project Gutenberg eBook #10. Public domain. Zacchaeus.

1 And Jesus entered and passed through Jericho. 2 And, behold, there was a man named Zacchaeus, which was the chief among the publicans, and he was rich. 3 And he sought to see Jesus who he was; and could not for the press, because he was little of stature. 4 And he ran before, and climbed up into a sycomore tree to see him: for he was to pass that way. 5 And when Jesus came to the place, he looked up, and saw him, and said unto him, Zacchaeus, make haste, and come down; for to day I must abide at thy house. 6 And he made haste, and came down, and received him joyfully. 7 And when they saw it, they all murmured, saying, That he was gone to be guest with a man that is a sinner. 8 And Zacchaeus stood, and said unto the Lord: Behold, Lord, the half of my goods I give to the poor; and if I have taken any thing from any man by false accusation, I restore him fourfold. 9 And Jesus said unto him, This day is salvation come to this house, forsomuch as he also is a son of Abraham.

The Pilgrim's Progress · the dream begins

John Bunyan, The Pilgrim's Progress from This World to That Which Is to Come. Project Gutenberg eBook #131. Public domain. This sitting: the opening of the dream only — not the verse Apology, not the whole book.

As I walked through the wilderness of this world, I lighted on a certain place where was a Den, and I laid me down in that place to sleep: and, as I slept, I dreamed a dream. I dreamed, and behold, I saw a man clothed with rags, standing in a certain place, with his face from his own house, a book in his hand, and a great burden upon his back. I looked, and saw him open the book, and read therein; and, as he read, he wept, and trembled; and, not being able longer to contain, he brake out with a lamentable cry, saying, "What shall I do?"

Stop here. A man in rags, a book, a burden, "What shall I do?" Next week continues from this picture. Do not read on today.